



Impacting-- **WHY Should We Care??**

Olivia Pasquerella

CWDAI



Claim

Warrant

Data

Analysis

Impact

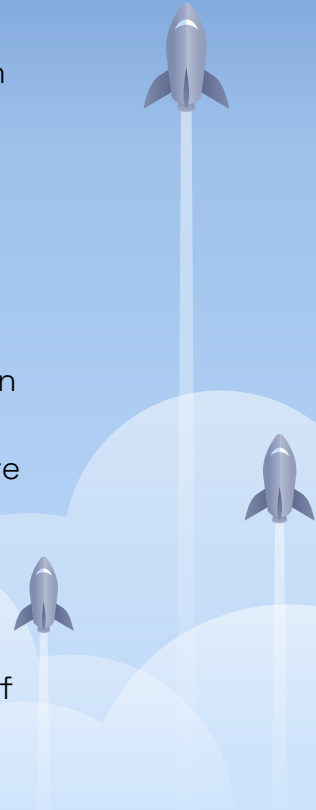
POV- You are a judge at an online tournament. You have minimal knowledge about the topic at hand. You are fighting the urge to fall asleep. Which argument would you prefer?



Here's What You're Evaluating-- Two Aff Args on Congressional Term Limits

1.) Pass today's legislation to decrease the influence of corporate lobbyists. James Snyder (professor of poli sci @ MIT) found that 97% of corporate super PAC \$ in elections funds the campaigns of incumbents. The more time someone spends in office, the stronger their relationship with PACs & lobbyists become, & without term limits, there are no restrictions on this problem. Look to Martin Giles, a political scientist from Princeton Uni, who found that it is the wealthy and their interest groups who play the most substantial role in Congressional policy, while the general public has LITTLE OR NO influence. Senators, it is clearly time to revamp our political system if we want to truly be a democracy, so pass.

2.) Pass today's legislation to end the chokehold of the incumbency advantage on our elections. A Ballotpedia analysis of the 2020 election found that Congressional incumbents in as many as 38 states were re-elected 100% of the time. W/ rates like these, all you have to do is win an election once and you virtually have a lifetime appointment. Section 2 of today's legislation puts a definitive stop to this problem by preventing every politician from serving more than 4 terms in the House & 2 terms in the Senate. Limiting the # of times Congress people can use their incumbency to their advantage to win elections virtually w/o contest finally gives challengers a chance of success. If you want to restore some semblance of competition in our elections, then you must stand on the affirmation.



The Correct* Answer Is...

*yes, this is very subjective but it is clear one impacts and the other does not

ARGUMENT 2 because...



- ☐ It tells us why we should care
- ☐ Actually proves the thing it sets out to prove
- ☐ Clear logical link from claim to evidence to analysis to impact
- ☐ References the part of the legislation that leads to the stated impact

The best speakers in Congress often do not have the most, or even the best available pieces of data. They select a few pieces of evidence to weave into an argument that mainly consists of their own analysis and impacts. They walk the judges through a thought process that arrives at a conclusion.



What is an IMPACT?

Why is it important?

- Clear explanation of WHY your point matters, WHO it affects, and HOW
- MOST IMPORTANT PART OF YOUR SPEECH-- impacts end up being refuted most of the time (even though they really shouldn't be-- go for data/analysis); establishes pathos
- Situate your argument in the real-world-- social hierarchies, economy, political environment, international stage, etc.

HOW do we impact?

Good arguments have a broad SCOPE or strong MAGNITUDE. GREAT arguments have BOTH.

1.) SCOPE: 🌍 the NUMBER of people impacted by the positive or negative outcomes of the legislation

a.) “Millions of Americans will be forced to pay extra for travel under a gas tax”; “passing guarantees supplementary funding for every public school”

2.) MAGNITUDE: 💣 how strongly those people are impacted positively or negatively (note- it is better to have an argument with strong magnitude and “weak” scope than great scope and weak magnitude because of how certain policies disproportionately impact particular minority groups)

a.) “Today’s legislation creates no alternative to receive the UBI other than depositing the money into a citizen’s bank account, meaning the small minority of very poor Americans who cannot open a bank account cannot receive the money they desperately need.”

Examples of Arguments With Strong Impacting

- ★ Millions of Americans will lose their financial lifeline and ability to put food on the table when you pass. (large scope, strong negative magnitude)
- ★ Passing demonstrates to every nation in the world that the United States stands on the side of democracy and the rights of the Taiwanese people. (large scope, strong positive magnitude)
- ★ Voter ID laws will disproportionately disenfranchise black Americans because they are statistically more likely to lack valid photo ID, thus continuing the silencing of voices of color in American democracy. (large scope, strong negative magnitude.)



HUMANIZE YOUR IMPACTS!!

Don't just throw out buzzwords and expect anyone to care. No one cares about “hegemony”/ “influence”/ “economic competition” unless you can explain how it somehow leads to the improvement of someone's everyday material conditions.

PRACTICE: Given the C,W,&D come up with a possible A & I.

C: Increasing the minimum wage reduces income inequality

W/D: stat about how an American can work a current minimum wage job 70 hrs/week, 52 weeks a year and still be below the poverty line

W/D: piece of data that suggests 32 million Americans would see annual income increase by \$5,000

Possible "I"s: more \$ for low-income Americans to pay the rent/put food on the table/not deny necessary medical care; incentivize more spending, which mitigates harms of COVID recession, gives all Americans (regardless of class) a cut of prosperity of the booming digital age economy



A space shuttle is shown launching from a launchpad, ascending into a blue sky filled with white clouds. The shuttle is white with orange and black markings. A large plume of white smoke and fire is visible at the base of the shuttle. In the foreground, there are some industrial structures and a green field. The overall scene is a dramatic representation of a space launch.

ROUND STRATEGY/ WHY WE IMPACT:

- Judges are human beings with their own lives, backgrounds, and opinions. Most have empathy!!
- Judges tend to pay the most attention at the end of things-- the impact is your big finish/ mic drop moment
- You need to debate like you really care, like there are really people out there whose lives are ruined or saved every day by Congressional action/inaction because THERE ARE. It is very easy to tell who does not actually care.

**NOW GO OUT AND
IMPACT!!**

